

● UNIT 2 · TOPIC 2.10

Fare Rules and Restrictions

The small print that decides what a passenger can — and cannot — do.

B.B.A. Aviation Management · Semester III · Unit 2: Fare Construction Principles
Air Ticketing & Fare Construction (2ACBAM32) · Arun Kumar

AIR TICKETING ACADEMY

ADMIT ONE LEARNER

No. 2.10

CLASS

**PROBLEM-
SOLVING**

DURATION

40 MIN

PERIOD

PERIOD 10

FARE

FREE**FARE
CHECKED**

- TOPIC 2.10

Now Showing: Topic Intro



The graphic is a dark red rectangular box with a subtle radial pattern. On the left, it contains the text 'UNIT 2 · TOPIC 2.10' in a small red box, followed by 'FARE CONSTRUCTION PRINCIPLES' in small white letters. Below this is the main title 'Fare Rules and Restrictions' in large, bold, white font. Underneath the title is a quote: 'The small print that decides what a passenger can — and cannot — do.' To the right of the quote is a large white play button icon. On the right side of the box is a white rectangular area with a dashed border, resembling a ticket. It contains the text 'AIR TICKETING ACADEMY' and 'ADMIT ONE LEARNER' at the top. In the center is 'No.2.10' in large, bold, dark red font. Below this, it says 'CLASS SEM III' and 'FARE FREE'. A red circular stamp with the words 'FARE CHECKED' in white, slanted letters is placed over the bottom right corner of the ticket area. At the bottom left of the dark red box, it says 'AIR TICKETING & FARE CONSTRUCTION · UNIT 2 · TOPIC 2.10' with a small airplane icon to the right.

UNIT 2 · TOPIC 2.10

FARE CONSTRUCTION PRINCIPLES

Fare Rules and Restrictions

The small print that decides what a passenger can — and cannot — do.

AIR TICKETING ACADEMY
ADMIT ONE LEARNER

No.2.10

CLASS SEM III FARE FREE

FARE CHECKED

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Air Ticketing & Fare Construction · Unit 2: Fare Construction Principles · Topic 2.10

02

● TOPIC 2.10

The Ticket Puzzle

**THINK ABOUT IT**

Why can't you change a cheap air ticket for free, like a bus ticket?

**THINK**

30 seconds alone

**PAIR**

1 minute with a neighbour

**SHARE**

2-3 answers with the class



TOPIC 2.10

Your Fare Itinerary

1**2.10.1**

Understanding fare rules: how airlines define restrictions

2**2.10.2**

Common restrictions: advance purchase, minimum/maximum stay and blackout dates

3**2.10.3**

Refund and change rules

4**2.10.4**

Real-world examples of fare rules applied to flight scenarios

**BY THE END, YOU WILL**

- Read a fare rule display
- Apply AP, stay and blackout rules
- Determine change and refund outcomes
- Solve fare-rule scenarios

Pedagogy: Learning Through Problem-Solving

● TOPIC 2.10.1

Fare Rule Categories (ATPCO)

Rules are filed in numbered categories — agents read them in the GDS.

Cat	Rule	Cat	Rule
1	Eligibility	8	Stopovers
3	Seasonality	11	Blackout dates
5	Advance res / ticketing	16	Penalties
6	Minimum stay	31	Voluntary changes
7	Maximum stay	33	Voluntary refunds

● TOPIC 2.10.1

Why Airlines Use Fare Rules

**Segment customers**

Leisure travellers accept rules for low prices; business travellers pay for flexibility.

**Protect revenue**

Stops business travellers buying the cheapest fares.

**Manage demand**

Blackouts and seasons steer travel to quieter dates.

**REMEMBER**

Rules are part of the contract. When a passenger buys a fare, they accept its conditions — the agent's job is to explain them before payment.



● TOPIC 2.10.2

The Big Three Restrictions



Advance Purchase

Book and ticket X days before departure, e.g., 14 days.



Min / Max Stay

E.g., stay over a Saturday night; return within 1 month.



Blackout Dates

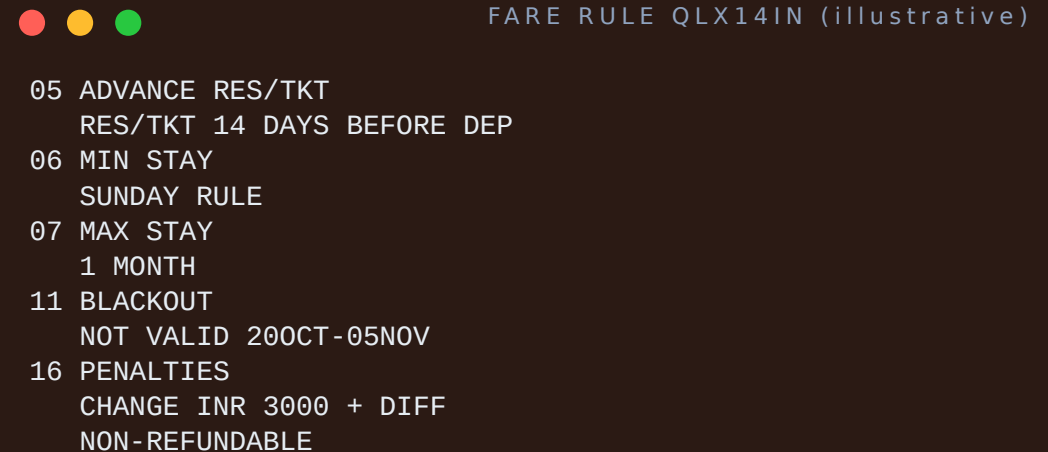
Fare not valid on peak dates such as Diwali or Christmas.

● TOPIC 2.10.2

Reading a Rule Display

A simplified fare rule.

- Check each category that matters for the trip.
- Advance purchase: 14 days.
- Stay: minimum Sunday rule, maximum 1 month.
- Blackouts and penalties listed in full.



FARE RULE QLX14IN (illustrative)

05 ADVANCE RES/TKT
RES/TKT 14 DAYS BEFORE DEP

06 MIN STAY
SUNDAY RULE

07 MAX STAY
1 MONTH

11 BLACKOUT
NOT VALID 20OCT-05NOV

16 PENALTIES
CHANGE INR 3000 + DIFF
NON-REFUNDABLE

● TOPIC 2.10.3

Voluntary Changes vs Refunds



Changes (Cat 31)

- Change fee (if any)
- Plus fare difference
- May need a new fare basis
- Reissue the ticket

VS

Refunds (Cat 33)

- Refund penalty or non-refundable
- Taxes of unused sectors refunded
- Partial use: used portion deducted
- Refund via original payment mode



● TOPIC 2.10.3

Solving a Change Request

**Read Cat 31**

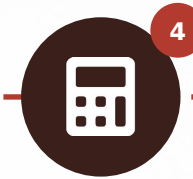
Are changes allowed?

**Change Fee**

Note the penalty

**New Fare**

Reprice new date

**Difference**

New – old fare

**Collect & Reissue**

Fee + difference

● TOPIC 2.10.4

Scenario Lab

Apply the QLX14IN rule from the earlier slide.

Scenario	Allowed?	Why
Booked 10 days before departure	No	Fails 14-day advance purchase
Out Friday, back Saturday	No	Sunday rule not met
Departs 25 October	No	Blackout 20 Oct-5 Nov
Change return date	Yes	INR 3,000 + fare difference
Cancel and refund	Taxes only	Base fare non-refundable

● TOPIC 2.10.4

Change Cost Calculation

₹7,500

original fare

₹9,200

new fare for new date

₹4,700

₹3,000 fee + ₹1,700 difference



If the new fare is lower, many rules do not refund the difference — check Cat 31.

● TOPIC 2.10

Ticket Office Workshop: Rule Detective Cases

**PEDAGOGY****Learning Through Problem-Solving****TIME · 12 min****FORMAT · Pairs****1**

Each pair gets a fare rule and 5 passenger requests.

2

Decide: allowed or not, and cite the rule category.

3

Calculate the cost of any allowed change.

4

Write a short, polite explanation for one refused request.



● TOPIC 2.10

Click to reveal each answer

Fare Check Quiz

Q1**ATPCO Category 16 covers...**

- A) Eligibility
- B) Penalties
- C) Seasonality
- D) Stopovers

ANSWER**B****Q2****A “Sunday rule” is a...**

- A) Blackout
- B) Minimum stay condition
- C) Refund rule
- D) Baggage rule

ANSWER**B****Q3****Change cost usually equals...**

- A) Fee only
- B) Fare difference only
- C) Fee + fare difference
- D) Nothing

ANSWER**C****Q4****Dates when a fare cannot be used are...**

- A) Blackout dates
- B) Seasons
- C) Stopovers
- D) Validity

ANSWER**A**

TICKET STAMPED

Key Takeaways

- ✓ Fare rules are filed in ATPCO categories (5, 6, 7, 11, 16, 31, 33 are key)
- ✓ Advance purchase, stay and blackout rules limit cheap fares
- ✓ Change = fee + fare difference; refund depends on Cat 33
- ✓ Always explain rules before the passenger pays

EXIT TICKET Write 1 thing you learned today + 1 question you still have.

NEXT TICKET

Topic 2.11 — Fare Calculation Tools: ATPCO

Thank you · Questions?